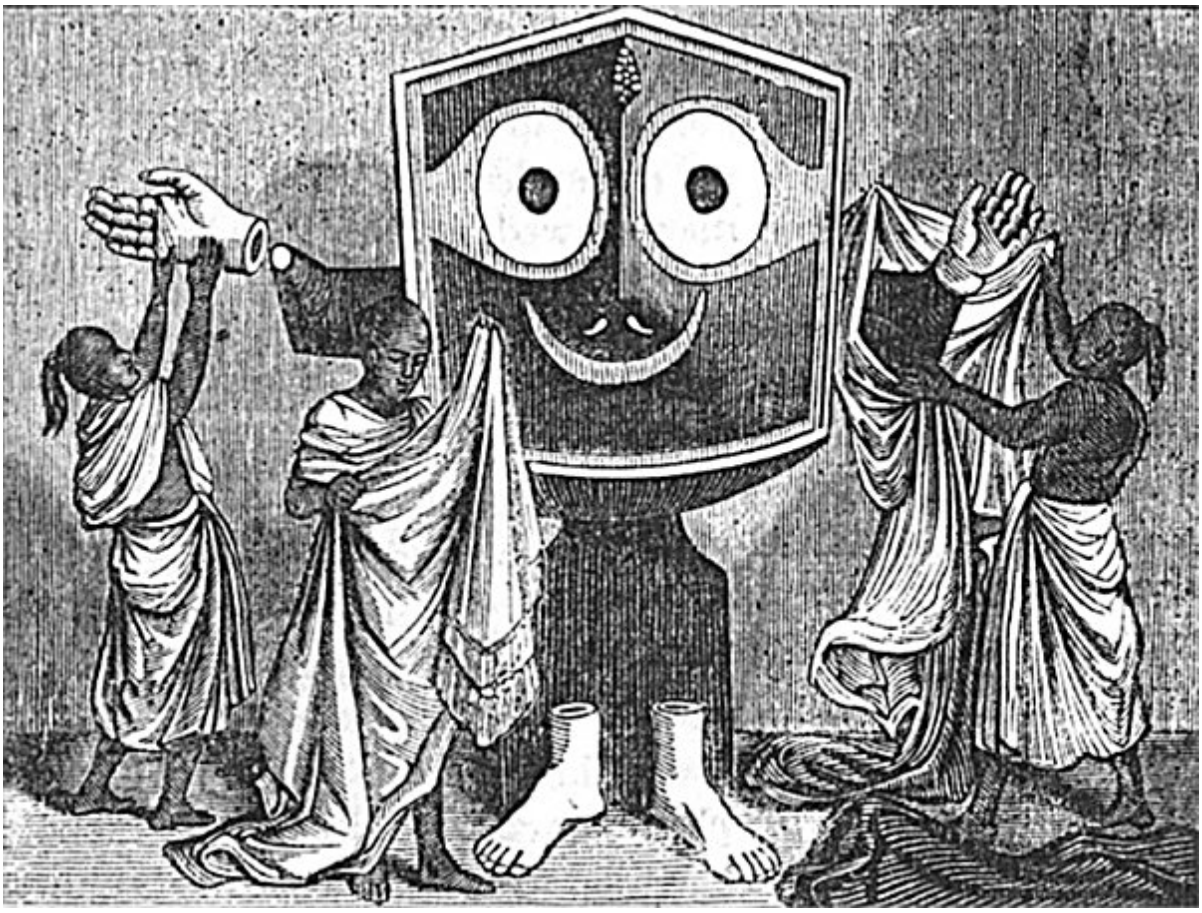
worshipper of Lord Jagannath. Only these Dayitapatis are involved in the replacement of the old *daru*s with the new within the inner temple, the last phase being performed by the three most senior members of the tribe, who are blindfolded and their hands bound in cloth. At dead of night the old *daru*s are then carried out by the Dayitapatis to be buried in their own cemetery in a ceremony that must not be witnessed by any but those involved, a prohibition taken so seriously that a black-out is imposed on the town of Puri for the duration of that night.



An engraving from 1869 showing the wooden core of the Jagannath *daru* being dressed by temple attendants.

But there may also be a very intriguing Buddhist element in all this. In 1837 James Prinsep, the genius who first translated the Brahmi script, began a correspondence with